

Building Apps with Meteor

Meteor is a powerful platform for Web app development and an interface at which the mobile world integrates with the Web world. The 'universal language everywhere' feature of Meteor makes it extremely simple for developers to write apps. So it's an option that's certainly worth considering for Web and mobile app development.



Meteor is an open source platform which provides a complete, full-stack framework for building Web and mobile applications entirely in JavaScript. It provides a very easy and delightful app-building experience with lots of cool features such as live updates, a unified package system, Websocket Microservices, etc. Meteor has a reactive programming model that extends all the way from the database to the user's screen. So let's explore how to build an app with Meteor.

Installing Meteor

Installing Meteor is pretty straightforward. There is just one command to be executed, after which you are all set. To install Meteor on OS X or Linux, run the following command from the terminal.

```
$ sudo apt-get install curl
$ curl https://install.meteor.com/ | sh
```

To install Meteor on Windows, just download the installer from <https://install.meteor.com/windows>, follow the wizard and it's all done.

This will install Meteor, MongoDB and almost everything you need to get started with.

Creating a new app

To create a new app, run the following command from the terminal:

```
$ meteor create meteorApp
```

This creates a new directory named *meteorApp* and places all the files in it.

Inside the *meteorApp* directory, the following three files are created by Meteor:

1. *meteorApp.js* contains all the JavaScript code which will be sent to both client and server
2. *meteorApp.html* is an HTML file to define views